

User Guide

How to build worship setlists, read chords and learn them on keyboard or guitar

One Church. One Sound. One Jesus.

Version 3.7.0

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1. What MDCHORD does

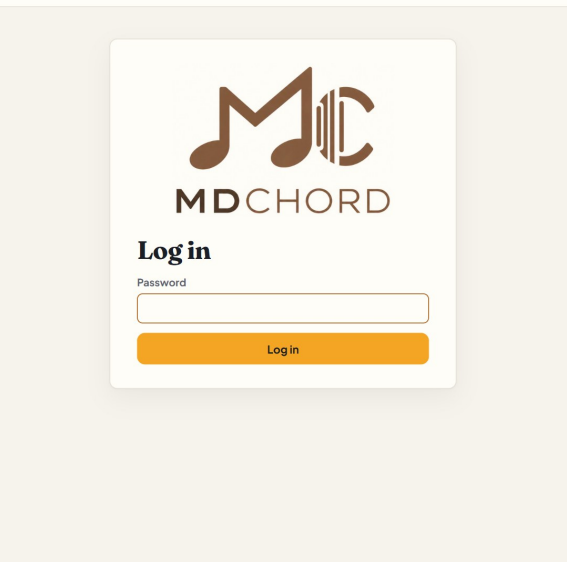
MDCHORD helps a worship team plan a service and play the songs. An **Event** (for example a Sunday service) holds **Songs**. Each song has lyrics with chords, a key, rhythm and tempo, and **Section Notes** for the team (who plays what, dynamics, cues).

You can:

- build an event from the shared song library, or paste in a chord sheet;
- see chords above the lyrics and tap any chord to see how to play it on **keyboard** or **guitar**;
- move a song to another key with one tap;
- keep time with the built-in metronome and set a tempo by tapping;
- export a song as a picture (PNG) and share a read-only link with the whole team.

2. Logging in

1. Open the app address given to you by your admin.
2. Type the shared password and press the login button.
3. You land on the **Events** list.



The login page.

> **Note:** The app is in testing mode. Everyone uses the same password and sees the same events, so check with the team before deleting or heavily editing something.

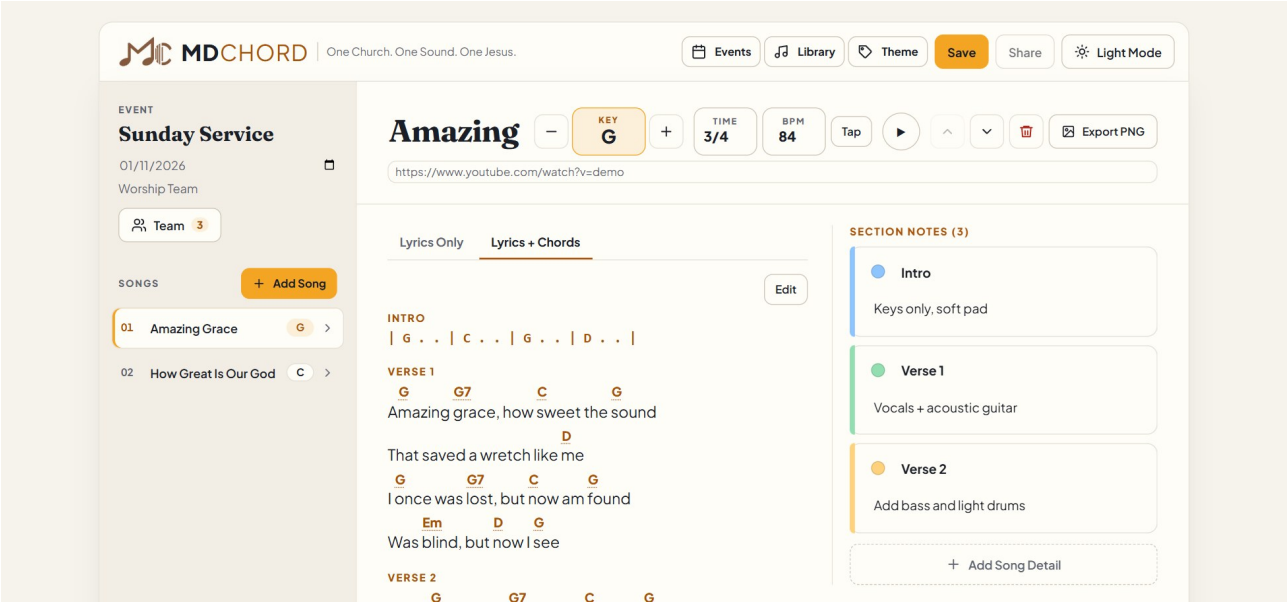
3. Your events

The **Events** page lists every event with its name, date, number of songs and owner. The sidebar on the left has three links: **Events**, **Library** and **Theme**.

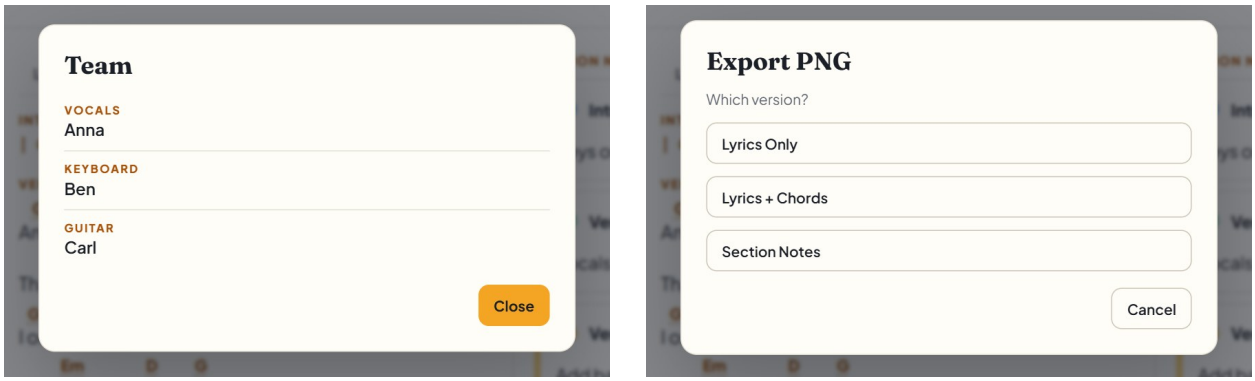
To...	Do this
Create an event	Press **New event**. An empty event opens in the editor.
Open an event	Click its title or press **Edit**.
Copy the share link	Press **Share** on the row. Paste the link anywhere.
Delete an event	Press **Delete** and confirm. This cannot be undone.
Filter the list	Choose an **Owner** and/or a **month** (for example Oct 2026).
Sort by date	Use **Date up / down**. Newest first is the default; events without a date go last.

4. Building an event (the editor)

At the top, fill in the **Event name** and **date**. Under the date you can set the **Owner** (free text) and open **Team** to list the people serving and their roles.



The editor. Songs are listed on the left (+ Add Song at the top), the song with its Key, tempo and Export PNG in the middle, and Section Notes on the right.



Left: the Team pop-up lists each person and role. Right: the Export PNG pop-up.

Add songs

1. Press **+ Add Song**.
2. Type at least 3 letters of the title, or any line of the lyrics.
3. Pick the song. Its lyrics, chords and key are copied into your event as an editable copy.
4. Or press **Add blank song** to start from nothing (see below to paste a chord sheet).

Song details and notes

Each song shows its **Key**, **Rhythm** and **BPM**, and an optional **Reference link** (YouTube, Spotify and so on). Song **Details** are coloured notes for the band, such as Intro, Verse or Bridge. Add, edit, reorder and delete them; press a colour dot to cycle its colour. Changes to an event copy never change the library original.

Saving

Changes **autosave** 1.5 seconds after you stop typing. You can also press **Save** at any time. If you try to leave with unsaved changes, the browser warns you.

> **Tip:** Press **Share** in the editor to copy the read-only link for the team.

Paste a chord sheet into a blank song

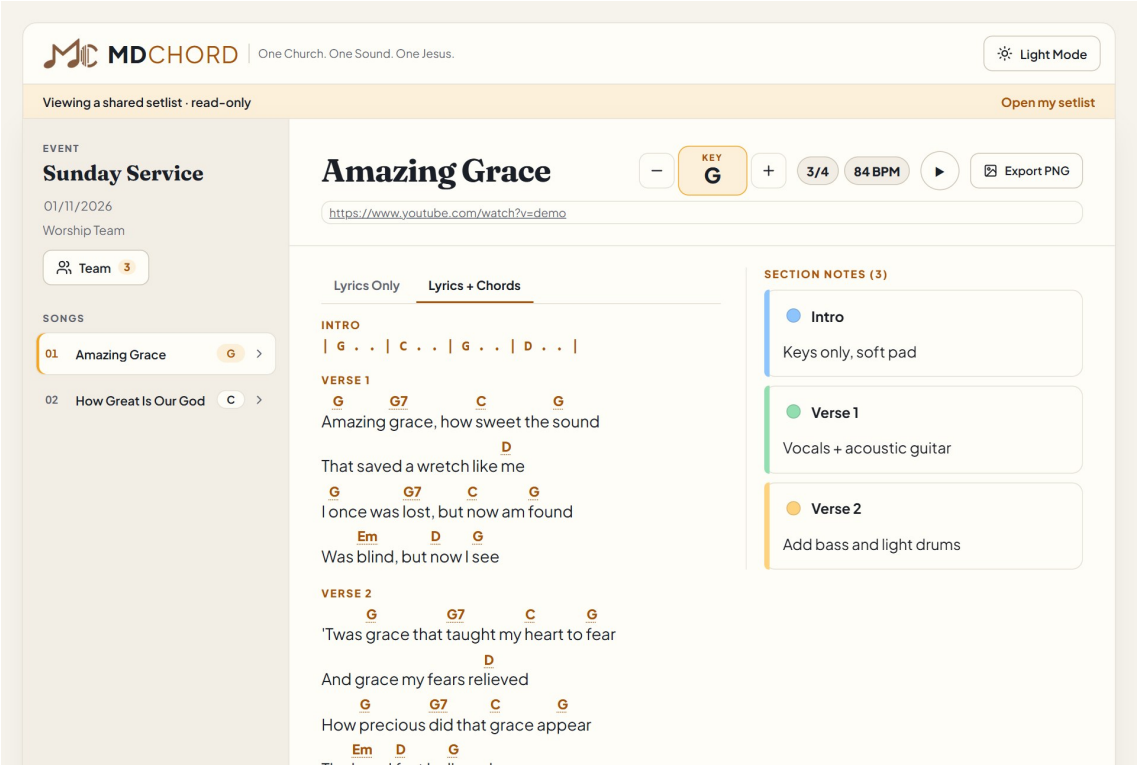
1. Press **Add blank song**, then open the **Lyrics + Chords** tab.
2. Paste a chord sheet copied from the web, with chords on their own line above the lyrics.
3. It is converted automatically. Empty title, key, rhythm and BPM are filled in from the sheet.
4. Press **Undo** to get back exactly what you pasted.

> **Tip:** If chords land a few letters off after copying from a website, press **Edit** and fix the spacing in the ChordPro text.

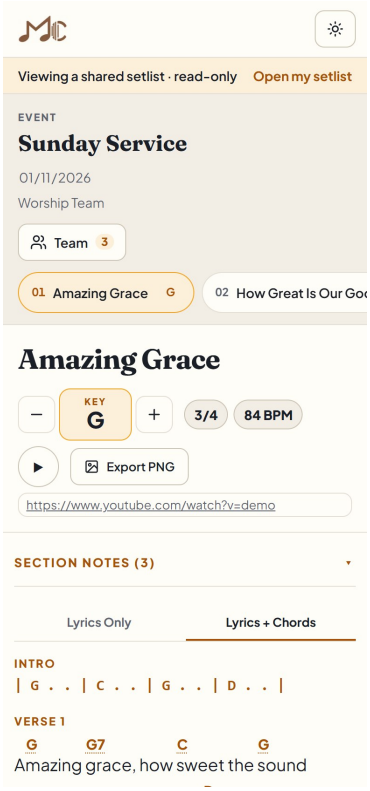
5. Reading a song

Every song has three tabs:

Tab	What you see
Lyrics Only	Large lyrics with no chords. Good for the congregation screen or a singer.
Lyrics + Chords	Chords above the words. Instrumental bars appear as | E . . . |. Press **Edit** to see and change the underlying text.
Section Notes	The coloured song details. On a tablet or PC they sit beside the song and follow you as you scroll. On a phone they fold into a **Section Notes** bar above the tabs: tap it to open.



A song on a share link (read-only): chords above the lyrics, Section Notes beside them.



On a phone the song takes the full width and Section Notes fold into a bar above the tabs.

6. Chord diagrams: keyboard and guitar

On the **Lyrics + Chords** tab, every chord is underlined with dots. **Hover** over a chord with a mouse, or **tap** it on a phone or tablet, to open the chord panel.

Action	Result
Hover (computer)	The panel shows briefly and closes when you move away.
Click or tap	The panel stays open until you close it (X button, Esc key, or click elsewhere).
Enter on a focused chord	Opens the panel and moves the keyboard focus into it.

Choose your instrument

At the top of the panel, choose **Keyboard** or **Guitar**. Your choice is remembered on that device, so you set it once.

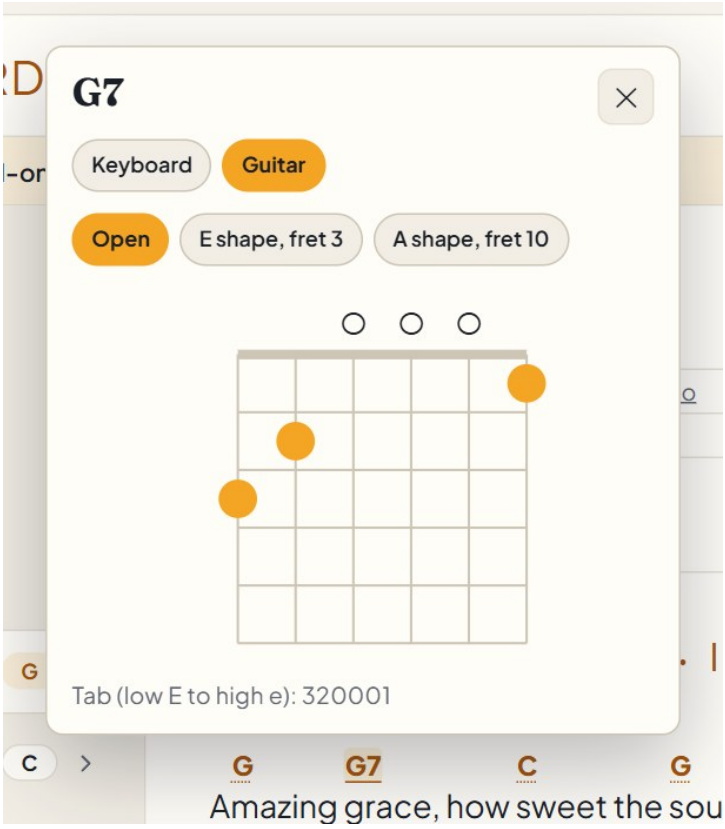
Keyboard



Keyboard: G7 in root position, with the notes on each key and the note list below.

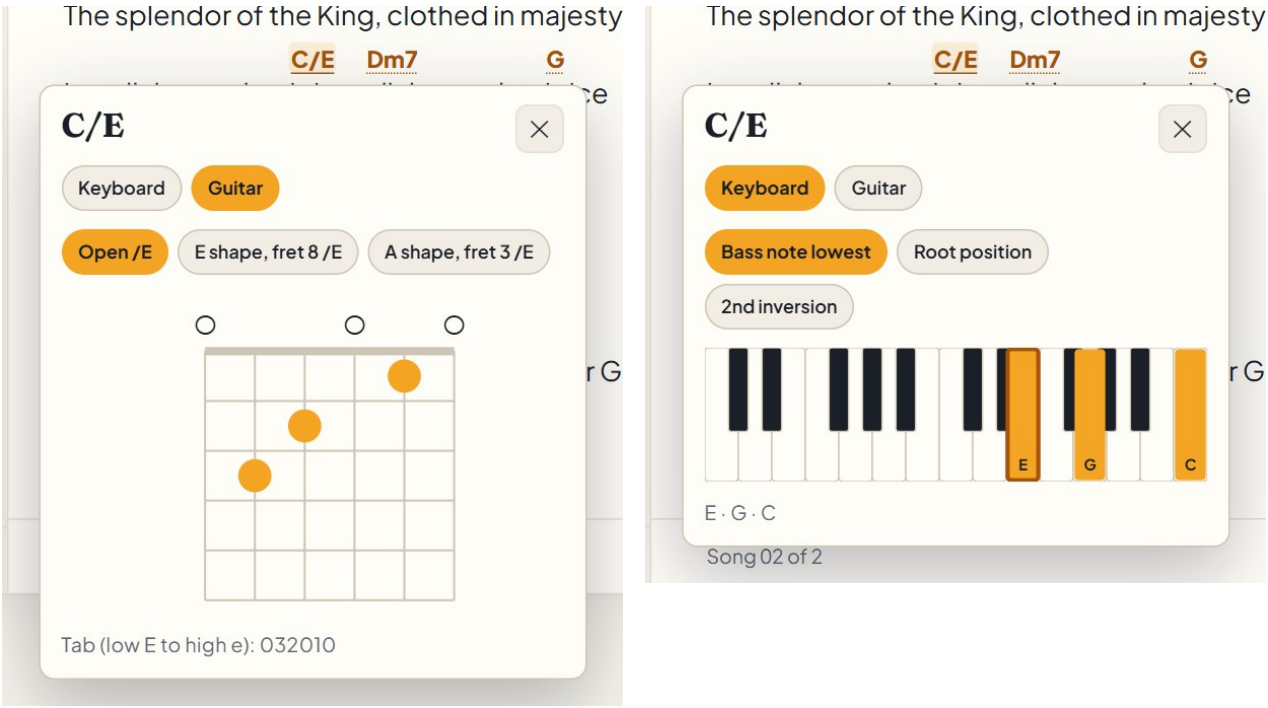
- A piano drawing highlights the keys to press, with the note name on each key.
- Buttons below offer 2 to 4 **voicings**: Root position, 1st, 2nd and 3rd inversion.
- For slash chords (such as D/F#) a **Bass note lowest** voicing puts the bass note at the bottom, marked with a heavier outline.
- Notes are spelled the way the chord is written: C9 shows Bb, not A#.

Guitar



Guitar: G7 open. The tab line reads 320001 from the lowest string to the highest.

- A fretboard drawing shows where to put your fingers. An **x** above a string means do not play it; an **o** means play it open. A label like **5fr** means the shape starts at the 5th fret.
- A **tab line** below the drawing reads from the lowest string to the highest, for example `x32010` for C.
- Up to 3 shapes are offered: **Open** (when one exists), **E shape** and **A shape** barre chords. Barre shapes slide up the neck to match the chord.
- Slash chords rebuild the shape so the bass note is the lowest note played.



The slash chord C/E on guitar (left, tab 032010) and on keyboard (right, E lowest).

> **Tip:** Chord diagrams are for learning only. They do not change the song and nothing is saved. A few rare chords may show "No guitar shape for this chord yet".

7. Changing the key

Beside the song's **Key**, press **minus** or **plus** to move the song down or up one semitone. All chords are rewritten (flats in flat keys). The chord diagrams follow the new key.

On a share link, these buttons change only **your own** view, never the saved event. Press **Reset** to return to the event's original key.

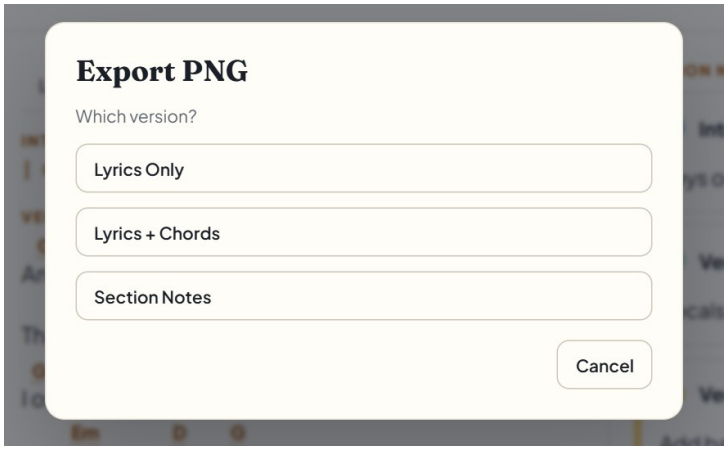
8. Metronome and Tap tempo

- The round **play** button next to the tempo fields clicks and flashes at the song's BPM. It keeps running when you change songs and follows each song's tempo.
- Browsers only allow sound after a click, so press it once each time you open the page.
- **Tap** next to BPM sets the tempo from your taps (the average of the last 6; a 2 second pause starts over). Use it in an event or when editing a library song.
- The metronome also works on share links.

9. Exporting a PNG

In the editor (or on a share link), press **Export PNG** and choose a version:

Choice	File name
Lyrics Only	*Title* - Lyrics.png
Lyrics + Chords	*Title* - Chords.png
Section Notes	*Title*.png



The Export PNG pop-up.

One click downloads the picture and closes the pop-up. Songs without lyrics have the two lyrics options disabled ("No lyrics yet"). The image follows the current light or dark theme and never includes the chord pop-ups.

10. Sharing an event

Press **Share** (on the Events list or in the editor) to copy a link that looks like `.../share/<code>`. Anyone with the link can view the event **without logging in**, but cannot change it. They see the songs, chords, notes, tempo badges and the team list, and can use chord diagrams, transposition (for themselves only), the metronome and Export PNG.

The link always shows the latest saved version, so you do not need to send a new one after editing.

11. The song library

The **Library** holds every song the team can add to events, listed A to Z.

To...	Do this
Find a song	Type in the filter box (title, artist or lyrics) and/or tick theme chips. A song shows if it has any ticked theme.
View or edit	Open a song, then press **Edit** to change its details, lyrics and chords.
Delete	Open the song and press **Delete**. Events keep their own copy.
See what changed recently	Each row shows when the song was last updated.

Add songs to the library

1. Open **Library**, then **Add songs**.
2. Paste a chord sheet, or upload one or more files (ChordPro or plain "chords above lyrics" text).
3. Press **Preview**. One card appears per song with title, artist, key, rhythm, BPM and themes. Problems such as duplicates, a missing key or an unreadable file are flagged.
4. Fix anything needed, then press **Confirm** on each ready card (or **Confirm all ready**).
5. Press **Save**. Only confirmed songs are saved.

> **Tip:** Rhythm starts at 4/4 and BPM empty. Lines like `Tempo:`, `BPM:` or `Time:` in the sheet fill them in. Pasted text stays in the box until its card is confirmed, so you can edit and press Preview again.

12. Themes

Themes label songs (for example Praise, Communion, Christmas). Open **Theme** in the sidebar to create, rename and delete themes. Deleting a theme removes it from every song. Tag songs with themes when you add or edit them, then use the theme chips in the Library to filter.

13. Quick reference and troubleshooting

Problem	What to try
Chord panel does not open	Make sure you are on **Lyrics + Chords**. Chords on instrumental grid lines and unknown symbols are plain text.
Panel closed by itself	It closes when you scroll or resize. Click or tap the chord again to reopen it.
Guitar tab says no shape	That chord has no guitar shape yet. Switch to **Keyboard**, or tell the admin.
No sound from the metronome	Press the play button once; browsers block sound until a click.
Chords misaligned after paste	Press **Edit** on the Lyrics + Chords tab and adjust the spacing.
Cannot find a song when adding	Type at least 3 letters. Search covers the title and any lyric line.
Share link does not open	Check the whole link was copied. Old links of the form `/?share=...` are redirected automatically.

Keyboard shortcuts

Key	Action
Esc	Close the chord panel.
Enter / Space	On a focused chord: open and pin the panel.
Tab	Move between chords and buttons.